



ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL
General Certificate of Education Ordinary Level

ENGLISH FOR COMMUNICATION
PAPER 2

4074/2
2 hours

SPECIMEN PAPER

Additional materials:
Answer booklet

Allow candidates 5 minutes to count pages before the examination.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the spaces provided on the answer booklet.

Read the provided passages very carefully before you attempt any question.

Check that the question paper has all pages and ask the invigilator for a replacement if there are duplicate or missing pages.

Answer **all** questions.

Write your answers on the separate answer paper provided using **black** or **blue** pens.

Leave a space of one line between your answers to each part of a question e.g. between 1(a) and (b). Leave a space of at least three lines after your completed answer to each whole question.

Answer question 3 from Section B on the grid answer sheet provided by Zimsec in the answer booklet.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question. Mistakes in spelling, punctuation and grammar may be penalised in any part of the paper.

This specimen paper consists of 7 printed pages.

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SECTION A: COMPREHENSION (15 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **45 minutes** on this section.

Read the following passage very carefully before you attempt any questions. Answer **all** the questions. You are advised to answer them in the order set.

Mistakes in spelling, punctuation and grammar may be penalised in any part of the paper.

The Informal Sector

- 1 One can find them in Africa's main towns and cities – food vendors, petty traders, motor mechanics, machinists, wayside foodstall operators and hundreds of thousands of others engaged in a variety of small scale trades and services.
- 2 These men, women and children work and survive on the shadowy fringes of the modern sector, outside the reach of many, and uncovered by national laws on wages, working conditions, safety and health. 5
- 3 Nevertheless, the informal sector plays an important economic role in urban centres in Africa. It employs more of the urban work force than the modern industrial sector, yet, it continues to be discriminated against by most governments.
- 4 Most of the informal sector activities are in retail trade, manufacturing and services. The informal sector plays a **significant** role in the urban and rural areas by producing and distributing goods and services. While it is largely regarded as a poor person's sector, some of its output meets the needs of the high income group. 10
- 5 The **scarcity** of capital in many of the less developed countries of Africa has not hampered the expansion of the informal sector. Research has shown that an informal sector entrepreneur tends to draw upon his/her own resources and those of relatives or family members to start his/her business. 15
- 6 There is indisputable evidence that in the prevailing economic conditions, the informal sector continues to provide an attainable opening for many **budding** entrepreneurs to start small scale undertakings. 20
- 7 Many of those enterprises, however, tend to die out within a short period of time, partly because of stiff competition and partly due to economic depression and **slackening** demand for their products. Their life expectancy ranges from an average of thirty-nine months, in the case of Lagos, to about seventy-nine months in Lome.
- 8 In other words, many informal sector enterprises cease to exist within three to seven years. The rising cost of raw materials, low productivity resulting from inadequate training and know-how and insufficient capital would seem to explain this phenomenon. 25
- 9 Official support and assistance to these entrepreneurs could prolong their 'life expectancy,' but the attitude of most African governments continues to be ambivalent. Governments do place strong emphasis in their development plans, on employment creation and basic needs satisfaction. However, the day-to-day reality is harassment of the informal sector. 30

- 10 Most governments have in fact been reluctant to implement laws to favour the informal sector or even put it at par with the formal sector. Much of this reluctance can be traced to official resistance to promoting what are considered ‘inferior’ quality products from the informal sector and to the proliferation of informal sector establishments, creating ‘shanty towns.’ Modern technology is often seen as the foundation for economic growth and since the informal sector enterprises concentrate on traditional technology, they are seen as inefficient and, as such, not deserving of government support. 35 40
- 11 That the informal sector should be allowed to operate on an equal footing with the formal sector is not disputed. Upgrading this important segment of national economic activity does call for help in many areas: vocational and managerial skills training for masters, artisans and apprentices, transfer of appropriate technology to improve quality and easier access to markets for the products of the informal sector. Such physically hostile policies as razing of informal premises must be stopped, so should certain unfriendly economic policies. 45
- 12 Given the requisite assistance, can the informal sector in Africa be the panacea for the continent’s chronic unemployment? Research shows that much of the employment generating potential of this sector has already been fully exploited. Judging by past experience, one should not expect the informal sector to completely cure the continent’s unemployment problem. 50
- 13 Certainly, the informal sector employs much more labour than the formal sector at the same level of capital stock. The fact is that it cannot be expected to continue to absorb all the growing numbers of migrants in the urban areas whose share in urban growth rate of most African countries is about seventy percent. 55
- 14 The informal sector would have to grow by ten to fifteen percent annually to absorb productively this high rate of population growth. Indeed, the traditional ‘safety valve’ role of the informal sector cannot be relied on indefinitely to absorb the stream of urban migrants in African countries. 60

Adapted from: “*The Informal Sector*,” in *Get Sharp Advanced Reading: Thinking and Writing Skills*, by R. East, A. Morrison and J Norton, Published by Zimbabwe Educational Books Pvt Ltd, (1990).

Answer **all** the questions. You are advised to answer them in the order set.

From paragraph 1

- 1 (a) Without giving examples, what activities are found in Africa’s main towns and cities? [1]

From paragraph 2

- (b) Give **one** disadvantage of working in the informal sector. [1]

From paragraph 3

- (c) What economic problem does the informal sector solve? [1]

From paragraph 4

- (d) From the information given in this paragraph, describe the writer's attitude towards the informal sector. [1]

From paragraph 5

- (e) In what **two** ways do informal sector entrepreneurs solve the problem of scarcity of capital? [2]

From paragraph 7

- (f) Suggest **two** ways by which the informal enterprises can overcome the problem of stiff competition. [2]

From paragraph 8

- 2 (a) Quote a **phrase of three consecutive words** that mean the same as 'to die out.' [1]

From paragraph 9

- (b) How do governments contradict themselves when dealing with the informal sector? [1]

From paragraph 10

- (c) Why are informal sector enterprises often seen as inefficient? [1]

From paragraph 14

- (d) '... this high rate of population growth.' What does this expression refer to? [1]

From the whole passage

- (e) Choose **three** of the following words or phrases which are in bold print in the passage. For each of them, give one word or a short phrase (of not more than seven words) which has the same meaning as the word or phrase in the passage.

1. significant (paragraph 4)
2. scarcity (paragraph 5)
3. budding (paragraph 6)
4. slackening (paragraph 7)
5. cure (paragraph 12)

[3]

SECTION B: SUMMARY (15 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **45 minutes** on this section.

- 3 Read the following passage carefully. Write a summary of the passage in **not more than 120 words**. Your summary should be in continuous writing (not note form). Each word should be written in a separate box on the grid answer sheet provided by ZIMSEC. If you make a mistake, cancel the word(s) and write the correct word(s) in the same box(es) above or next to the cancelled word(s). [15]

The Malaria Scourge

- 1 When it comes to malaria, only one thing is guaranteed. Every evening, in the rainy season across much of the world, Anopheles mosquitoes will take wing, alert to the odour and warmth of living bodies. A female Anopheles needs to drink blood every day. In a simple feeding, which lasts as long as ten minutes, she can ingest about two and half times her pre-meal weight in human terms, the equivalent of downing a bathtub-size milk shake. 5
- 2 If she happens to feed on a person infected with malaria, parasites will accompany the blood. Two weeks later, when the mosquito flies through the open window of a mud hut, seeking her next meal, she will be loaded.
- 3 Inside the hut, a child is asleep with her sister and parent on a blanket spread over the floor. The family is aware of the malaria threat; they know of the rainy season's dangers. They have hung a bed net from the ceiling. But it's a steamy night, and the child has tossed and turned a few times before dropping back to sleep. Her foot is sticking out of the net. The mosquito senses it and dips down for a silent landing. 10
- 4 The parasites remain in the blood stream for only a few minutes. They ride the channel of the circulatory system to the liver. Almost certainly, the person who has been bitten hardly stirs from sleep for the next week or two. There is no clear sight that something in the body has just gone horribly wrong. 15
- 5 We surely live on a malaria-infested planet. It may not seem that way from the vantage point of a wealthy country, where malaria is sometimes thought of, if it is thought of at all, as a problem that has mostly been solved, like smallpox or polio. In truth, malaria now affects more people than ever before. It is endemic to 106 nations, threatening half the world's population. In recent years, the parasite has grown so entrenched and has developed resistance to so many drugs that the most potent strains can scarcely be controlled. 20 25
- 6 The outcry over this epidemic, until recently, has been muted. Malaria is a plague of the poor, which is easy to overlook. The most unfortunate fact about malaria, some researchers believe, is that prosperous nations got rid of it. In the meantime, several distinctly unprosperous regions have reached the brink of total collapse due to malaria, virtually ruled by swarms of buzzing flying syringes. 30
- 7 Only in the past few years, has malaria captured the full attention of aid agencies and donors. The World Health Organisation has made malaria reduction a chief priority. Bill Gates who has called malaria 'the worst thing on the planet', has donated hundreds of millions of dollars for the effort through the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation.

- 8 Much of the aid is going to a few hard-hit countries scattered across sub-Saharan Africa. If these nations can beat back the disease, they shall serve as templates for the global anti-malaria effort. What if they can't? Well, nobody in the malaria world likes to answer that question. 35

Adapted from: *Bedlam in the Blood: Malaria* by Michael Finted in *The National Geographic* July 2007 Vol. 212 No 1, pages 41 – 67.

SECTION C: VOCABULARY AND REGISTER (10 MARKS)

You are advised to spend **30 minutes** on this section.

- 4 Given below are various situations. Read them carefully and then answer the questions that follow.

- (a) In the School Dining Hall, Tanya accidentally spills tea on Phil. Tanya says:

‘I’m sorry Phil. I didn’t see you coming.’

Write an appropriate response if Phil accepts the apology. [1]

- (b) You arrive home with your friend. You introduce him to your family saying:

“Everyone, meet my friend Tawanda. He’s a doctor at the local hospital and specialises in mental health.”

- (i) In what way does the introduction make it easy for your family to start a conversation with Tawanda? [1]

- (ii) Suggest Tawanda’s response to the family after the introduction. [1]

- (c) You have just imported your first car, a Nissan Note. Two different colleagues say the following:

Colleague 1: ‘What an achievement! I’m happy for you!’

Colleague 2: Congratulations! Just wait until you see my Toyota GD6 which is arriving next week!

What is your interpretation of the above statements.

Number your answers separately 1 for interpretation of Colleague 1’s utterance and 2 for interpretation of Colleague 2’s utterance. [2]

- (d) You have learnt that your friend’s brother has died. You are supposed to break the news to him.

Write an appropriate way of conveying the above message to your friend. [1]

- (e) You have a birthday party at your home. Write an expression that
- (i) You would use to invite your teacher, Mrs Shamhu.
 - (ii) Mrs Shamhu would use to decline the invitation. [2]
- (f) You have just enrolled for Advanced Level at a local High School. One of your mates has chosen an indigenous language as part of his/her combination. Two learners make the following remarks.
- (i) 'You have chosen indigenous language! Do you want to be a witch doctor!'
 - (ii) 'That's a good combination. You will have great career opportunities.'

What different views are being expressed towards the learning of indigenous language by each of the speakers? [2]